

CHALLENGE #10: Search Source Write-up.

Search source

Medium

Web Exploitation

picoCTF 2022

AUTHOR: MUBARAK MIKAIL

Description

The developer of this website mistakenly left an important artifact in the website source, can you find it?

Additional details will be available after launching your challenge instance.

This challenge launches an instance on demand.

Its current status is:

NOT_RUNNING

Launch Instance

38,378 users solved

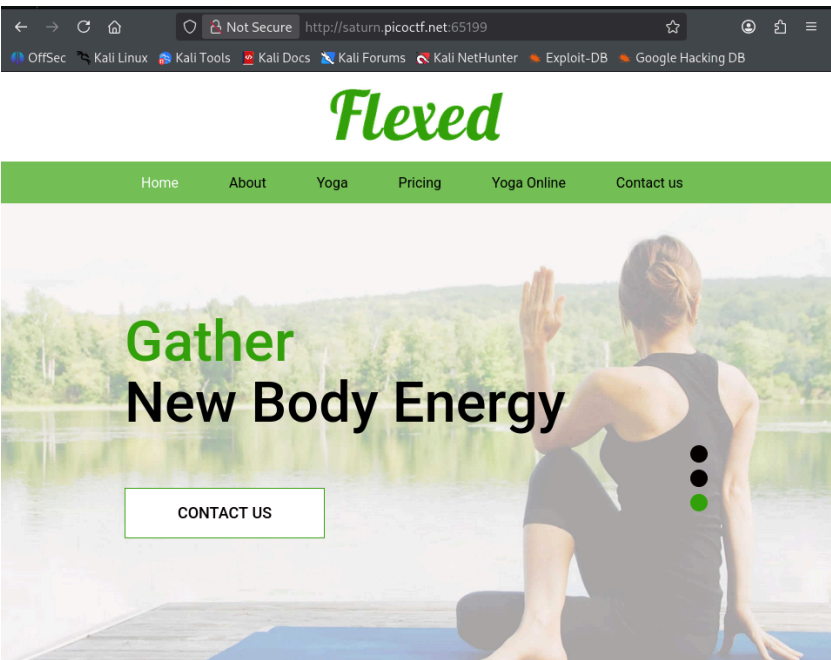
53%

Liked

picoCTF{FLAG}

Submit Flag

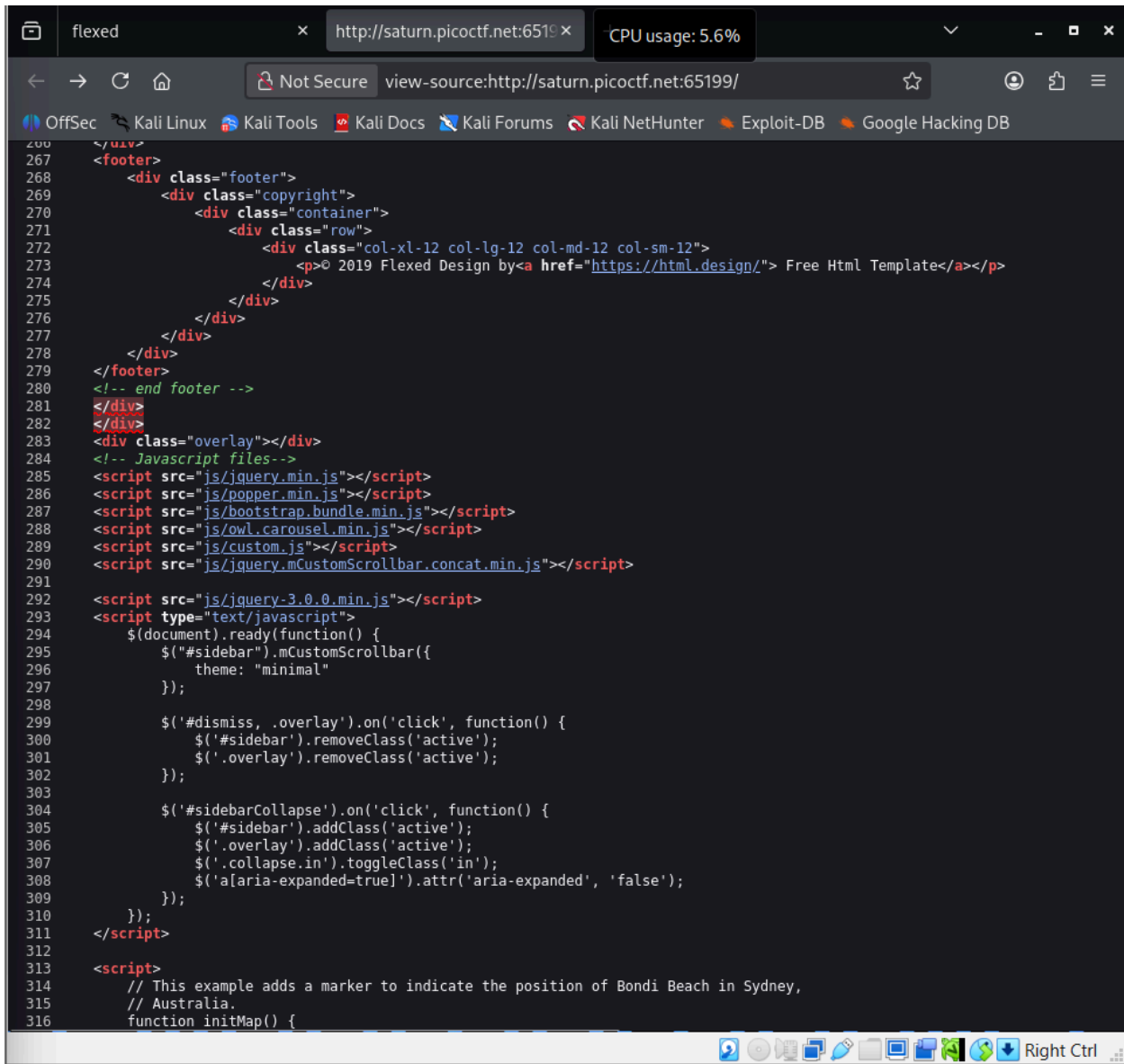
Solving Process:



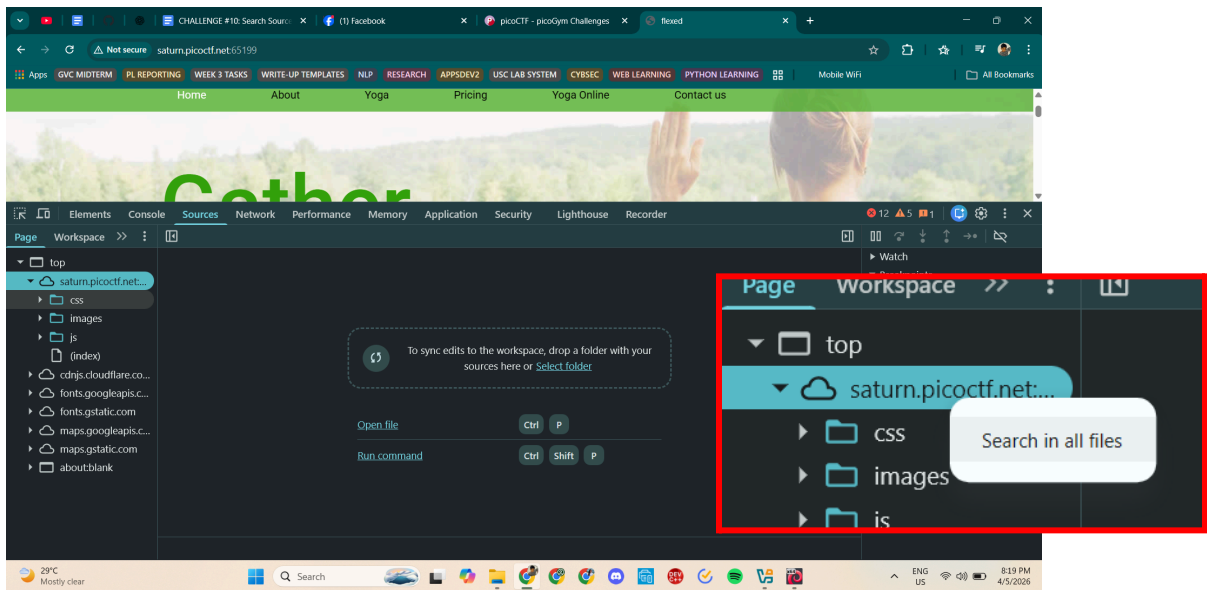
The webpage appeared to be a simple site, and the goal of the challenge was to **find the hidden flag within the website's source files**. The challenge description mentioned that the developer had left an **important artifact in the website source**, which suggested that the flag might be hidden somewhere within the page code or its related resources.

To begin the investigation, the page source was viewed. However, the HTML file contained hundreds of lines of

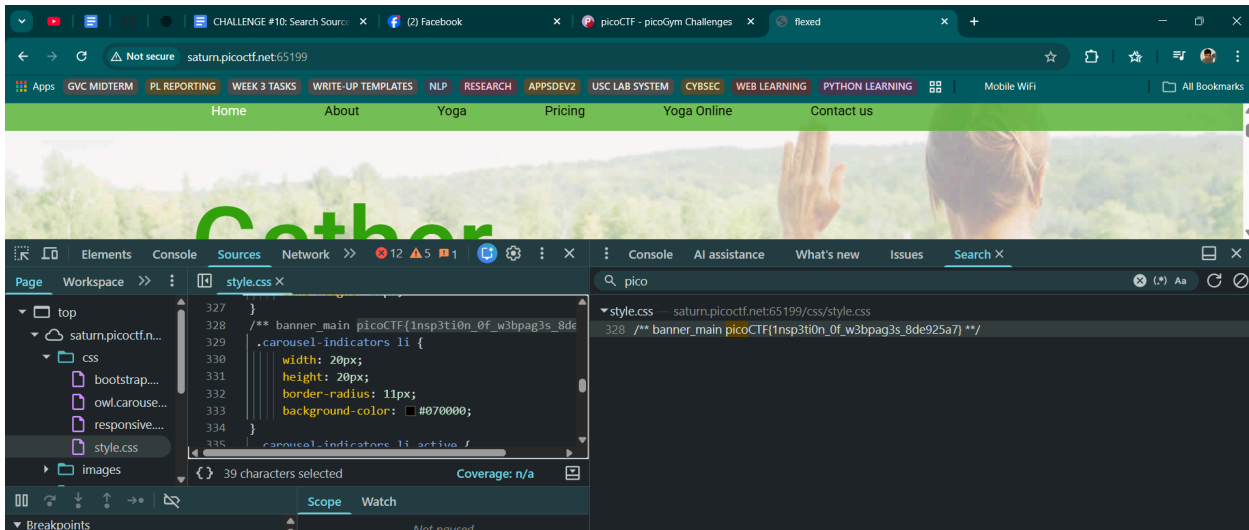
code and referenced many external CSS and JavaScript files, making it difficult to manually search through every file for the flag. Opening individual files also showed large amounts of code, which would make the process slow and inefficient if done manually.



To speed up the search process, I inspected the page. Since Google Chrome was used, the **Sources** tab was selected in the developer tools. This tab displayed all the files associated with the website, including the HTML, CSS, and JavaScript files, organized within the site's directory structure. Instead of checking each file one by one, the **search feature** within the developer tools was used. By right-clicking the website directory in the *Sources* panel and selecting **Search in all files**, it became possible to search for a specific string across all files loaded by the website.



Since flags in the challenge typically begin with the prefix “pico”, the keyword **pico** was entered into the search field. After executing the search, the developer tools quickly located a match within one of the CSS files, specifically inside the style.css file. Opening the file revealed that the flag was embedded within the CSS code. The flag was then copied and submitted to complete the challenge successfully.



MediumWeb ExploitationpicoCTF 2022

AUTHOR: MUBARAK MIKAIL

Description

The developer of this website mistakenly left an important artifact in the website source, can you find it?

The website is [here](#)

This challenge launches an instance on demand.

Its current status is: **RUNNING**

Instance Time Remaining: **14:55**

Restart Instance

Hints ?

1

How could you mirror the website on your local machine so you could use more powerful tools for searching?

38,378 users solved

53% Liked

picoCTF{1nsp3ti0n_0f_w3bpag3s_8de925a7}

Submit Flag

Hurray! You solved this challenge.

X

Reflection:

This challenge showed how important it is to inspect website source files carefully, since developers may accidentally leave sensitive information in the code. By using the browser's developer tools and the search feature across all files, it became much easier to locate hidden data within large amounts of source code. The activity emphasized the value of efficient investigation techniques and proper code review practices to avoid exposing sensitive information in web applications.